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Our fascination for space and its orbital objects is well known. There's an almost zero percent chance that anyone would say no to see our planet from an altitude of 3,60,000 feet. Companies like Virgin Galactic and XCOR Aerospace have been at the forefront of taking space travel to a commercial level.

The scenario

Virgin Galactic seems to be the closest to realise the dream of commercial space travel. They have started building a spaceport (that's what an intergalactic travel port will be called) where the first flight will take off from. Their spacecraft, 'SpaceShip Two', can carry six passenger astronauts and two pilot astronauts. This will increase as the programme becomes cheaper with time. XCOR Aerospace doesn't truly provide you with an outer space experience as its spacecraft will only take you for a spin around the lower earth orbit. Virgin Galactic's current base at the Mojave desert cost it \$9.7 million and work on assembling the first Spacecraft has begun.

The cost

You can book a seat on the Virgin Galactic programme for \$20,000 with the entire trip costing you \$200,000. Already, 40 aspiring astronauts have registered for it. The XCOR plan is much cheaper than booking a ticket on Richard Branson's spacecraft – you'll be burning a hole worth \$95,000 in your pocket with \$20,000 of it being the booking amount.

The preparation

A trip to outer space, even if the intended tour only lasts for a couple of hours, requires basic safety and zero gravity training. There's a minimum training period of four days to make you feel



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